Most of the time people feel that Yoga is about physical exercise while research shows that Yoga is a mix of body exercise and meditation. Practicing Meditation and Yoga prepares our body and soul for the day

MANISH SISODIA
Deputy Chief Minister, Delhi

Dilli Ki Yogshala during Covid-19

In the wake of the COVID-19 pandemic, people reported heightened feelings of distress, anxiety and vulnerability. During this time, several health and medical benefits of Meditation and Yoga were realised worldwide. Dilli Ki Yogshala was an essential driver of impact at such a time by preparing modules of asanas and pranayamas specifically for people suffering from COVID. Citizens could enrol and attend these carefully designed 45-60 minute online classes. Approximately 4700 citizens participated in the Government of NCT of Delhi program.

According to findings by DPSRU, 92.3% of patients shared improvement in overall symptoms of COVID immediately. The classes gave them something to look forward to during their isolation period and helped reduce some of their stress and anxiety. Medically, it was seen that individuals who were regular practitioners were recovering faster and kept in better health even post-COVID and the lingering after-effects of COVID were seen to be kept at bay through the practice of Meditation and Yoga.

Apart from serving the people of Delhi through free Meditation and Yoga classes, the program also adopts a multifaceted approach by aiming to develop a sense of community amongst all. The program seeks to create a positive space for interactions, engagements and inclusive discussions between people from society, creating a supportive circle to share one's thoughts.

The Delhi Government aims to make mental and physical well-being a priority for all individuals with this one-of-a-kind program being accessible to citizens across Delhi. The government plans to expand to regions across Delhi and more centres will be made available to the people. With the help of this initiative, the GNCTD aims to make mediation and Yoga more accessible to citizens across Delhi and turn it into a mass movement.

Centre for Meditation and Yoga Sciences (CMYS)

The instructors for this program are rigorously trained and certified through the Centre for Meditation and Yoga Sciences (CMYS), Delhi Pharmaceutical Sciences and Research University (DPSRU). The Government of Delhi, working closely with the Delhi Pharmaceutical Sciences and Research University (DPSRU) established the Centre for Meditation and Yoga Sciences (CMYS) in 2021. The centre offers a Diploma and Certificate course in Meditation and Yoga Sciences. Additionally, as the program emphasises on inculcating a sense of community and togetherness, the curriculum is designed to include 'personality development' as an essential element in building deeper and meaningful student-teacher relationships with the participants.

I am preparing for Civil Services for the last 2 years. My family supported me immensely, however, I could not contribute much financially. Working as a Yoga instructor under the Dilli ki Yogshala has helped me contribute financially to my family. It fills me with self-confidence and also helps me prepare better for my aspiration.

YOGA INSTRUCTOR 'DILLI KI YOGSHALA'

I am glad to be a part of Dilli Ki Yogshala and I really appreciate our Delhi Government's initiative. Being a housewife I used to feel low on confidence, but after joining this enthusiastic program, I feel so mentally, physically, and socially confident by interacting with the participants and teaching them the asanas. It gives me immense joy to be able to contribute to this great initiative.

YOGA INSTRUCTOR 'DILLI KI YOGSHALA'